

Today's Session at a Glance

- **Class:** Current affairs session (recorded) covering all important current affairs up to the morning of 8 October, plus the West Bengal paper. Other papers released recently are shared on Telegram - have a look at them.
- **Topics today:** (1) Nobel Prize in Chemistry; (2) India's military exercises (Mountain Guardian and others); (3) RBI Monetary Policy Committee - repo rate hike; (4) assorted GK questions (Asian Games, Prarthana Samaj, Somnath, CWG, Vivekananda, Navy fleet support ship).

Thought of the Day

- All our dreams can come true - but only if we have the strength to run after them and the capacity to follow them. Merely thinking that a task will get done is not enough; effort has to be put in.
- Even Lord Rama did not just 'think' of finishing Lanka - he worked hard and travelled all the way there. *You have to put in the efforts.*

Class Announcements and Study Advice

- **SSC CHSL crash course** is live: the teacher's classes start from **12 October**; other lectures are also starting. Join if you have not. The class PDF is available on Telegram.
- **From Monday** (second day of Navratri) the class will add **monuments** and restart the **revision** sessions - attend classes regularly.
- **Weekly MCQs** are held on **Sunday** and are meant for reading/practice.
- Weekly/monthly current affairs alone will **not** get you selected. They are enough only for one-day exams (e.g. an LIC exam or Agniveer); for other exams, regular daily classes are needed.
- Admit cards usually arrive only 2-3 days before the exam (for a 13th exam date, expect it a couple of days earlier). All batches are added in the Super Pass Live.

Topic 1: Nobel Prize in Chemistry 2026

The Nobel season is on and an award is being announced almost every day. Announced so far: **Medicine** first (the teacher shared a short mnemonic for it, heard as 'MDH / NDH' - unclear in the transcript), **Physics** second (one winner - **Francis Halzen**, as named in class), and now **Chemistry**, the third.

Key facts

- **Awarded for:** the development / discovery of the **single molecular mirror** (mirror-image molecules, i.e. 'mirrored molecular' structures).
- **Winners (2 people):** **Henri (Henry) Kagan** and **Kenso Soai** (heard in class as 'Henry Kagan' and 'Kan/Kenso Soi'). Kagan and Soai both studied this area.
- **Field:** Organic Chemistry - they studied mirror (mirrored) molecules, for which the award was given.
- **Alternative wording in an exam:** if 'mirror molecule' is not written, the question may show the term '**Non-linear effect**' - their study. Questions may be asked indirectly, not straight-forward.
- **Awarding body:** Royal Swedish Academy of Sciences. **Place:** Sweden (same venue as the other Nobel announcements).
- **Prize money:** 12 million (Swedish) Krona - same as the other prizes.

Related history (likely to be asked)

- **Indian winner in Chemistry:** **Venkatraman (V.) Ramakrishnan - 2009**.
- India's Nobel in **Literature** came in **1913** (but the question here is about Chemistry).
- **Chemistry 2025 (last year):** three winners - **Susumu, Richard and Omar**. Last year's year can also be asked, so note both the current and previous winners.

Quick Revision - Nobel Chemistry

- Chemistry = 3rd Nobel announced this season | 2 winners: **Henri Kagan + Kenso Soai** | Topic: **mirror molecules** (keyword: **non-linear effect**) | Organic Chemistry.
- Given by Royal Swedish Academy of Sciences | Sweden | 12 million Krona.
- Indian winner: **V. Ramakrishnan, 2009** | 2025 winners: Susumu, Richard, Omar | Physics this season: Francis Halzen.

Topic 2: Military Exercises (India)

Exercise Mountain Guardian 2026 (India - UAE)

- **Meaning of the name:** the 'guardian of the mountains' - it protects the mountains.
- **Between:** India and UAE. **Edition:** **First edition** - being held for the first time, in 2026.
- **State:** **Uttarakhand** (Devbhoomi) - hosted at **Chaubatia** (spelt 'Chaubatiya').
- **Venue:** a foreign training centre/node at Chaubatia, where the exercise is conducted.
- **Dates:** started **5 October** and runs till **18 October** 2026.
- **Important point:** participation of **women officers** is also seen in this exercise.

Other India - UAE and related exercises

- **Desert Cyclone** - India and UAE. If only '**Cyclone**' is asked - it is an exercise with **Egypt**.
- **Desert Flag** - India, UAE and also **France** take part. Remember all exercises linked with the words 'Desert' and 'Cyclone'.

Latest exercises (if asked 'which exercise was held recently')

Exercise	Between / With	Note
Yudh Abhyas	India and USA	Recently conducted
Mitra Shakti	India and Sri Lanka	Recently conducted
Nomadic Elephant	India and Mongolia	Heard as 'Nodik Elephant'
Mountain Guardian	India and UAE	First edition, Uttarakhand, 5-18 Oct

Quick Revision - Exercises

- **Mountain Guardian** = India-UAE, 1st edition, **Uttarakhand (Chaubatia)**, 5-18 Oct 2026, women officers took part.
- **Desert Cyclone** = India-UAE | **Cyclone** = Egypt | **Desert Flag** = India, UAE, France.
- **Yudh Abhyas** = USA | **Mitra Shakti** = Sri Lanka | **Nomadic Elephant** = Mongolia.

Topic 3: Assorted GK from the Class

- **Asian Games - Javelin:** the Indian athlete eyeing a **hat-trick of gold** in javelin throw is **Neeraj Chopra**. (Rohit's name was among the options - he won a **bronze**; the shot-put person's name was also an option but is linked with shot put.)
- **Asiatic Society founder (correction from yesterday):** **William Jones** - not Warren Hastings. Correct your notes.
- **Prarthana Samaj** (Maharashtra): founder / architect named in class is **M. G. Ranade**.
- **'Central Bank of India'** in a general question means the **RBI**.
- **Somnath Temple** (destroyed by **Mahmud Ghazni**): dedicated to **Lord Shiva (Bholenath)**; located in **Gujarat**.
- **Commonwealth Games:** the 2022 and 2026 editions were distinguished in the question; the **2030** Games will be held at **Ahmedabad, Gujarat**.
- **Swami Vivekananda's Chicago speech** (Parliament of the World's Religions - 'Brothers and sisters...'): year **1893**. Options were 1891, 1893, 1895, 1897 - 91 and 97 are ruled out; it is 93 (not 95).
- **Navy - First Fleet Support Ship:** Defence Minister **Rajnath Singh** launched India's first fleet support ship for the Navy on **6 October**. The question asked *where* it was launched from - the transcript cuts off here, so the place is not recorded.

Quick Revision - GK

- Neeraj Chopra (javelin hat-trick bid) | Asiatic Society: William Jones | Prarthana Samaj: M. G. Ranade.
- Somnath = Shiva, Gujarat, Ghazni | CWG 2030 = Ahmedabad | Vivekananda Chicago = 1893 | Fleet Support Ship launched 6 Oct.

Topic 4: RBI Monetary Policy - Repo Rate Hike

Sanjay Malhotra, Governor of RBI, announced the policy. This is an important economics topic - listen carefully, your economics base comes from here.

Monetary Policy Committee (MPC)

- **Formed: 2016. Meetings: 6 times a year** - i.e. every second month.
- **Members: 6** in total - **3** from RBI (including the RBI Governor) and **3** nominated by the Government of India.
- **Head:** the **RBI Governor** chairs the meeting - Mr. Malhotra.
- **What is discussed:** inflation rate, repo rate, RRR (class said 'triple R') and GDP.

Decisions announced

Item	Decision / Figure
Repo rate	Increased by 25 bps from 5.25% to 5.5% - the first increase in 3 years
MSF rate	Also increased (no need to memorise the number)
Stance	Also changed (heard as 'stance')
RRR	Fixed - no change. Remember what changed, not the RRR number.
GDP forecast	7.1% - the World Bank also says 7.1% for India
Inflation	5.2% - prices are rising (Navratri fruits, Diwali, Karwa Chauth - everything gets costlier)

What is the Repo Rate?

The rate of interest the **RBI charges when it lends money to banks** (for example SBI) as a loan. It is also called **RR** in class. RBI uses it to manage the flow of money in the market and investment; the class explained that more investment improves GDP. Earlier the repo rate was 5.25%; it is now **5.5%**. (Note: in standard economics a repo rate hike generally tightens money flow and curbs inflation - class explanation recorded as taught.)

Reasons for the hike (may be asked in the paper)

- The **rupee** has become much **weaker**.
- **Inflation** is rising very fast.
- **Crude oil prices** keep rising.
- **Agriculture:** the **kharif crop** has been badly damaged / wasted.
- **Global (international) tensions.**

Impact on common people

- **Home loan EMI** becomes costlier.
- **Car and personal loans** - higher interest to be paid.
- **Cost of anything you get built / project cost** rises (more to pay).
- **FD interest rates** will also see changes.

About the RBI

- RBI is India's **central bank**. **Symbol:** a **palm tree** and the **Royal Bengal Tiger**.
- **Formation:** under the **Government of India Act 1935** (as stated in class). Initially **HQ in Kolkata**; after **1937** shifted to **Mumbai**.

Quick Revision - RBI / MPC

- MPC: formed **2016** | 6 meetings a year | 6 members (3 RBI incl. Governor + 3 Govt) | Chair: **RBI Governor Malhotra**.
- Repo **5.25% to 5.5% (+25 bps)**, first hike in 3 years | MSF up, stance changed | RRR fixed | GDP **7.1%** (RBI + World Bank) | Inflation **5.2%**.
- Reasons: weak rupee, high inflation, crude oil, kharif crop damage, global tension. Effects: costlier home/car/personal loans, FD rate changes.
- RBI: central bank | palm tree + tiger | 1935 Act | Kolkata to Mumbai (after 1937).

All MCQs / Questions from Today's Class (with Answers)

A. Questions shown on screen

#	Question	Answer
1	The recent Nobel Prize in Chemistry was given for the development of the 'single molecular mirror'. Who received it?	Henri Kagan and Kenso Soai
2	Which Indian athlete eyeing a hat-trick of gold in javelin throw at the Asian Games? (Rohit won bronze; shot-put name is out)	Neeraj Chopra
3	Who is the founder / architect of Prarthana Samaj, formed in Maharashtra?	M. G. Ranade
4	Exercise Mountain Guardian 2026 between India and UAE is held in which state?	Uttarakhand
5	Whom is the 'Central Bank of India' generally taken to mean?	RBI
6	The Somnath Temple, destroyed by Mahmud Ghazni, is dedicated to which god? Where is it?	Lord Shiva (Bholenath); Gujarat
7	Where will the Commonwealth Games 2030 be held? (2022 and 2026 editions are different)	Ahmedabad, Gujarat
8	In which year did Swami Vivekananda deliver his Chicago speech (Parliament of World's Religions)? Options: 1891 / 1893 / 1895 / 1897	1893
9	India's first Fleet Support Ship for the Navy was launched by Rajnath Singh on 6 October - from where? (question cut off in transcript)	Not recorded
10	(Revision from yesterday) Who founded the Asiatic Society?	William Jones (not Warren Hastings)

B. Oral / in-class questions

#	Question	Answer
11	Who gives the Nobel Prize in Chemistry? Where? Prize money?	Royal Swedish Academy of Sciences; Sweden; 12 million Krona
12	Which Indian won the Nobel in Chemistry and when?	V. Ramakrishnan, 2009
13	Who won the Nobel Chemistry last year (2025)?	Susumu, Richard and Omar
14	Keyword that may appear instead of 'mirror molecule'?	Non-linear effect
15	Who won the Physics Nobel this season (as named in class)?	Francis Halzen
16	Desert Cyclone - between? 'Cyclone' alone - with? Desert Flag - who takes part?	India-UAE; Egypt; India, UAE, France
17	Yudh Abhyas / Mitra Shakti / Nomadic Elephant - with which country?	USA / Sri Lanka / Mongolia
18	Mountain Guardian: edition, venue, dates?	1st edition; Chaubatia; 5-18 Oct 2026
19	Year of formation of MPC? Meetings per year? Members? Who chairs?	2016; 6; 6 (3+3); RBI Governor
20	New repo rate after the hike? Old rate?	5.5% (from 5.25%, +25 bps)
21	GDP forecast (RBI and World Bank)? Inflation?	7.1%; 5.2%
22	Who announced the policy? Which rate stays fixed?	Sanjay Malhotra; RRR
23	RBI formed under which Act? HQ before/after 1937? Symbol?	GoI Act 1935; Kolkata then Mumbai; palm tree and tiger
24	Reasons for repo hike? Effects on people?	Weak rupee, inflation, crude, kharif damage, global tension; costlier EMI/loans, FD change